



TACTICAL EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

Win the moment before it wins you.

MARCUS TRUMAN

Archangel Performance Coaching · Focus Forum 2026 · St. Louis



THE NEXT 60 MINUTES

Here's where we're going

- 1 What EQ actually is**
— and why it's the one skill that moves performance.
- 2 Why you lose the moment**
— the hijack, and what's happening in your brain.
- 3 The tool: the Tactical EQ Loop**
— built from the military OODA Loop, inverted for the moment.
- 4 Run a rep — live**
— on one real moment of your own. You'll feel the skill work.

You'll leave with a tool you can use today.

PHINEAS GAGE

Railroad Foreman

1848 - Vermont

Known for his easy
smile and kind
demeanor

Authentic, honest,
hard-working

Cool under pressure

Industrious

Consistently met
company goals on time
and often under budget



PHINEAS GAGE



Leadership

Hard-working crew members were assigned to his crew as a reward

Genuine interest in others

Solution-Oriented

Enjoyed solving technical and management challenges

Known to step-in and get his hands dirty



EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

"When dealing with people, remember you are not dealing with creatures of logic, but creatures of emotion." - Dale Carnegie

What is Emotional Intelligence

The ability to sense, understand, and effectively apply the power of emotions to facilitate higher levels of collaboration and productivity.



WHY EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE MATTERS

"People who are emotionally adept - who know and manage their own feelings well, and who read and deal effectively with other people's feelings - are at an advantage in any domain of life." - [Daniel Goleman](#)



EQ drives 58% of job performance

Single biggest predictor of Leadership performance

90% of top performers are high in EQ

\$45,000 Annual income difference

Each point of EQ increase adds \$2,000

Improved injury / illness recovery

Increased Resiliency / Reduced chronic stress



WHAT DOES HIGH EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE LOOK LIKE

"Emotions can get in the way or get you on the way." - Mavis Mazhura

Display a strong emotional vocabulary
Sincerely curious about people
Know their Strengths and Weaknesses
Good sense of character
Learn from mistakes and move on
Embrace change
Assertive, not aggressive



PHINEAS GAGE

Suffered an accident

43" long, 13-pound tamping iron

Not only survived the injury
but was able to speak and
walk to the cart so he could be
taken to a doctor.



NEUROSCIENCE OF EQ

Lizard Brain

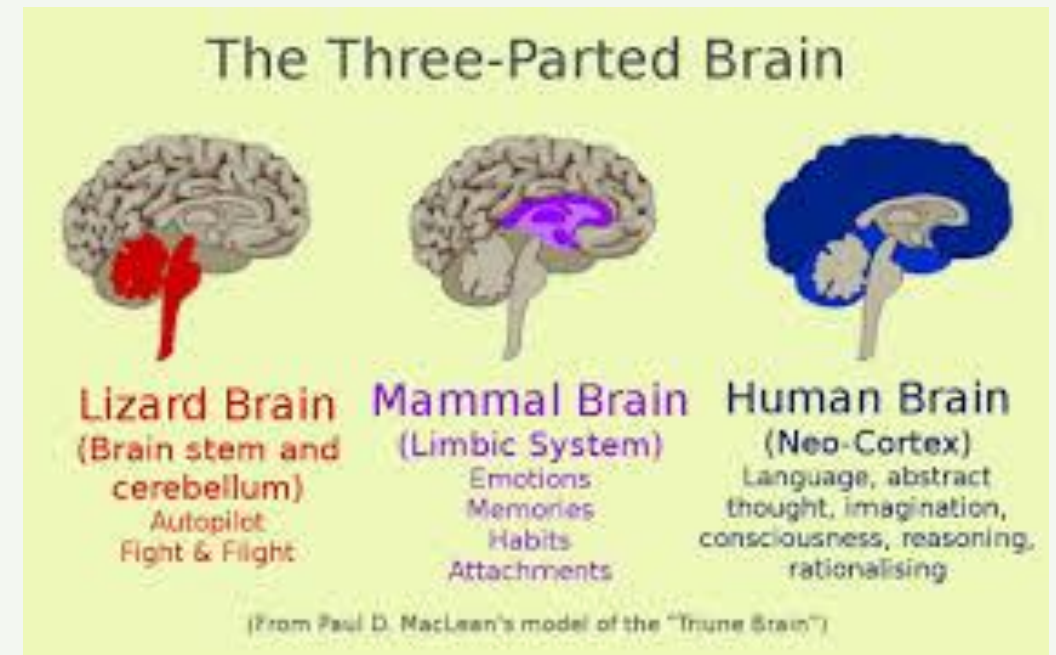
Survival
Autopilot
Sympathetic
Nervous
System

Limbic System

Emotions
Memories
Habits

Neo - Cortex

Language
Cognition
Problem -
Solving
Critical
Thinking
Inhibitions



PHINEAS GAGE



EQ...SKILL OR TRAIT?

Skill

Learned ability in a specific area, often developed and improved through practice and training

Trait

Inherent or innate characteristic that defines a person's nature



IQ VS EQ. TRAIT VS SKILL



IQ vs EQ

Intelligence Quotient (IQ) measures cognitive abilities, while Emotional Quotient (EQ) measures emotional and social skills.



Trait vs Skill

IQ is considered a relatively stable trait, while EQ is a set of skills that can be developed and improved over time.

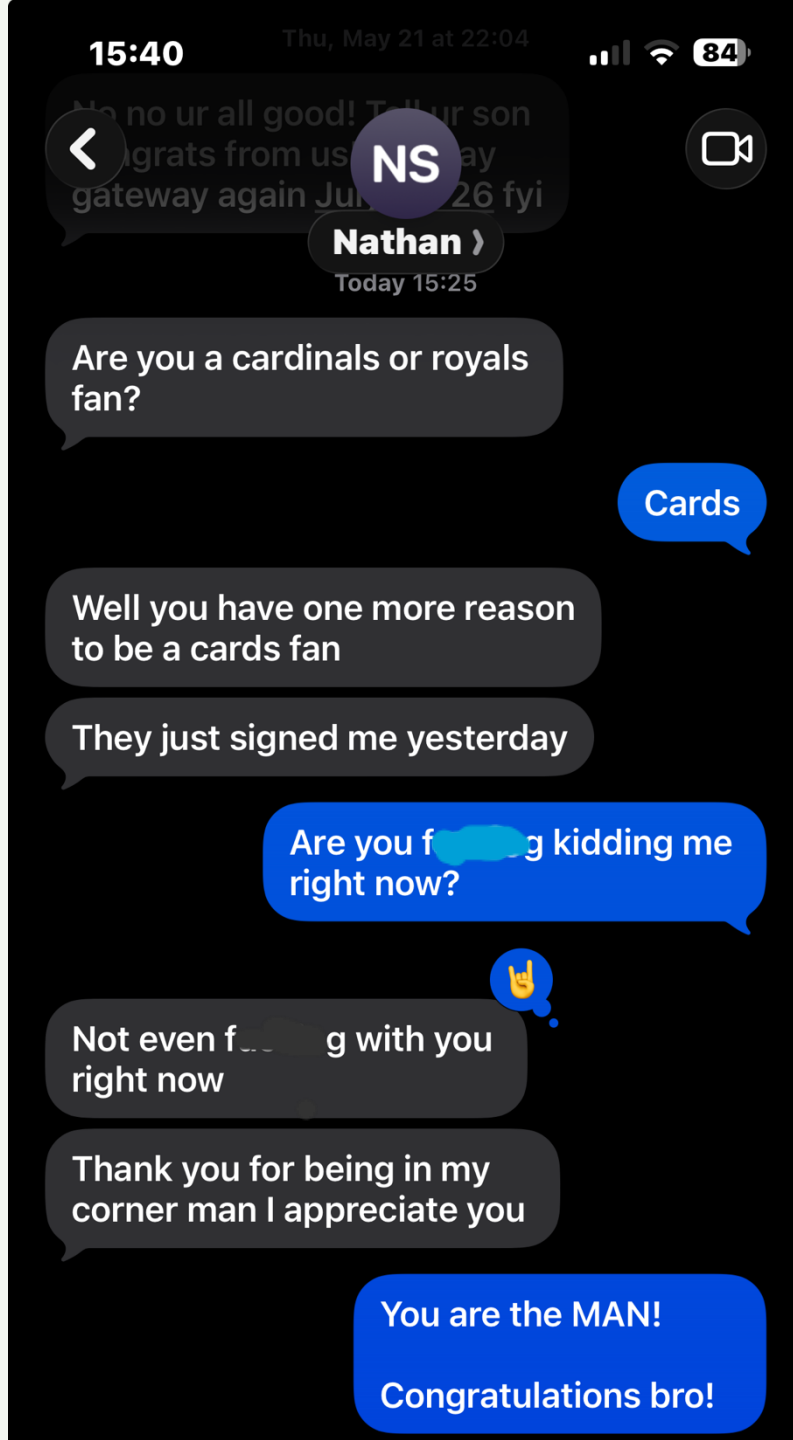
Understanding the distinction between IQ and EQ is crucial for leaders to effectively harness their emotional intelligence and cultivate strong interpersonal relationships.



EMOTIONAL FITNESS

Vs

PHYSICAL FITNESS



EMOTIONAL FITNESS

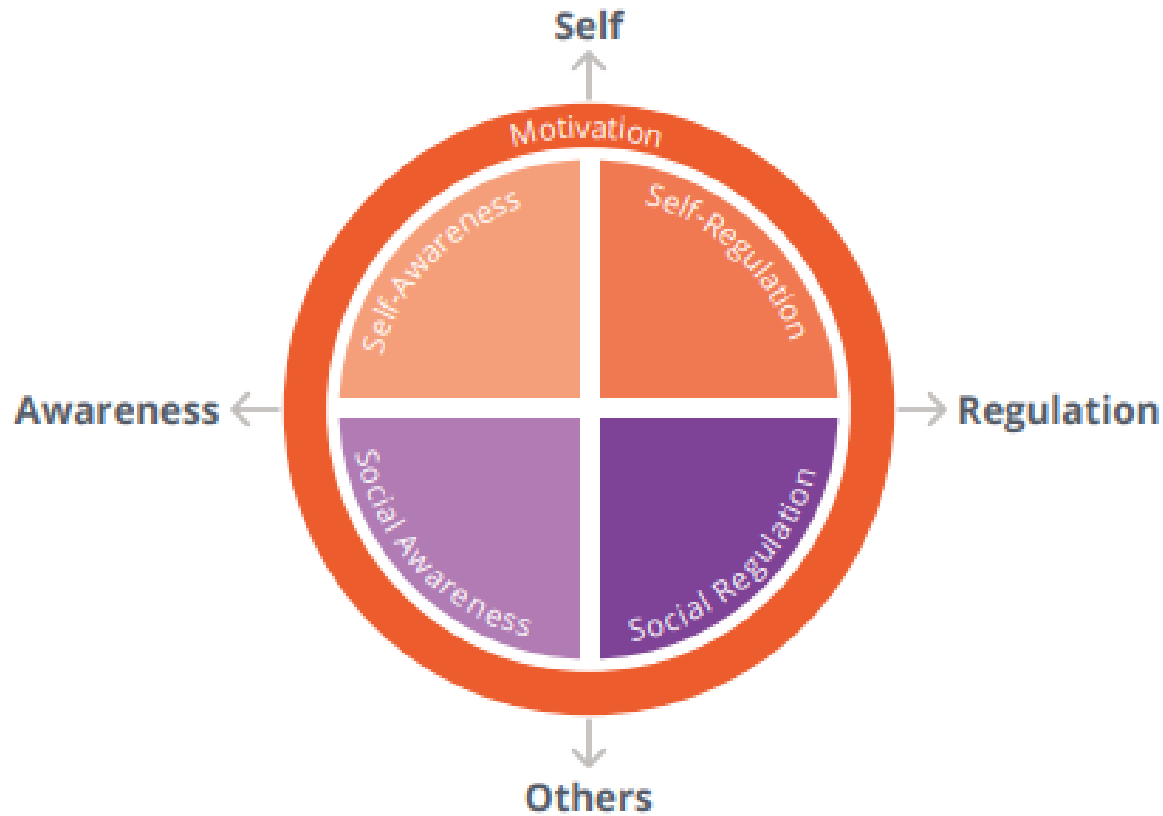
Vs

PHYSICAL FITNESS



OPEN-LOOP VS CLOSED-LOOP

THE DIMENSIONS OF EQ

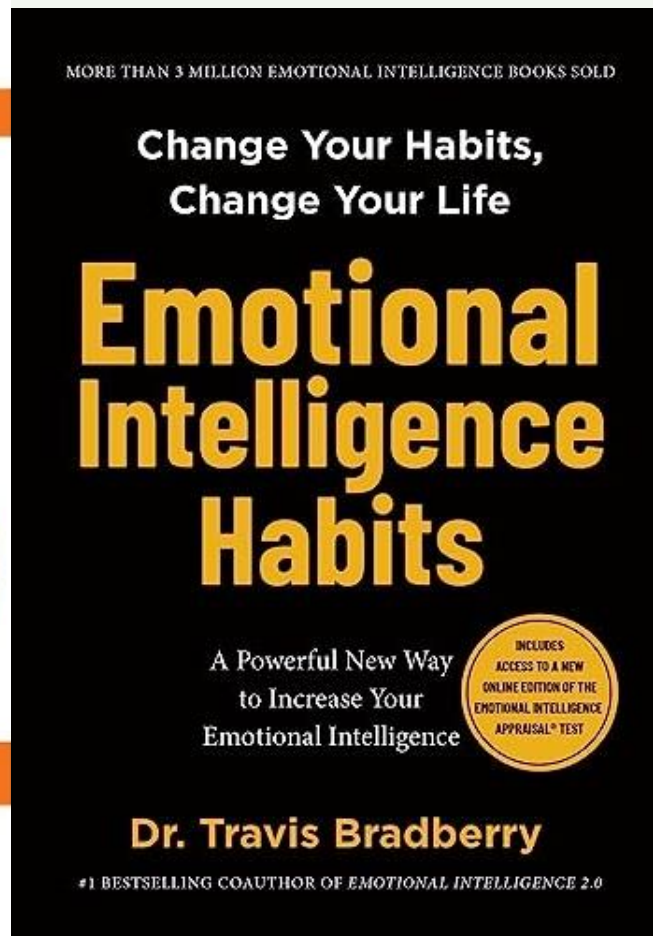
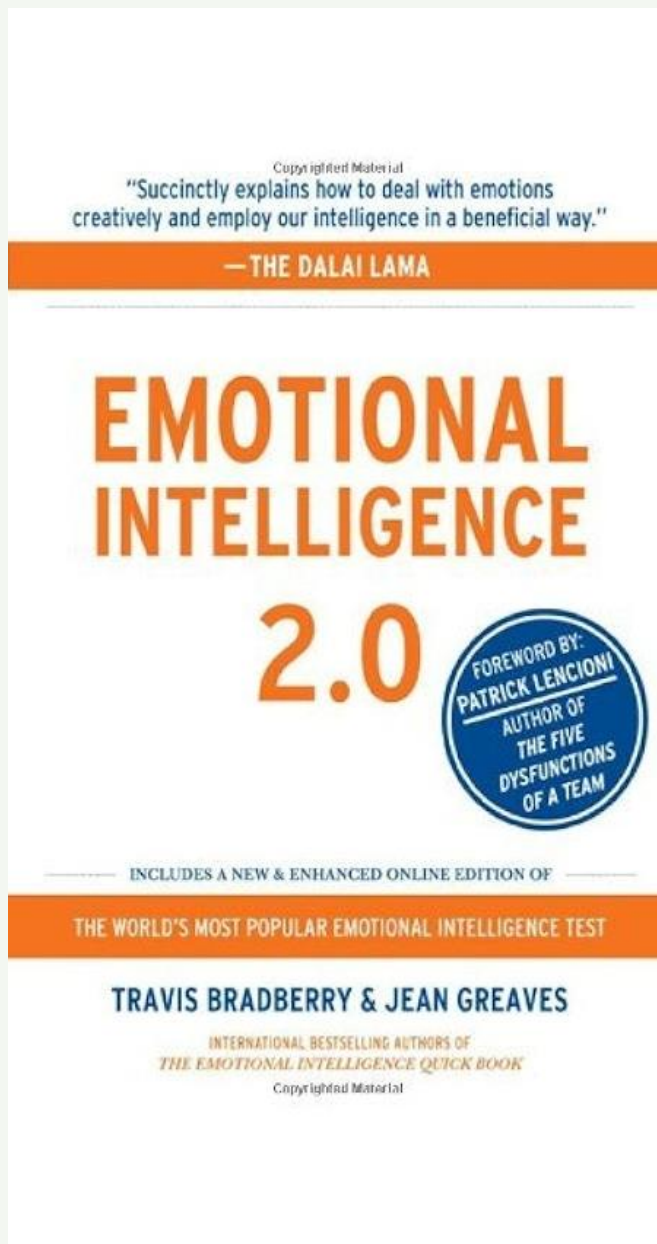


- **Self-Awareness**
Recognize and understand your moods, emotions, and their effect on others

- **Social Awareness**
Understand others' emotional makeup and how your actions affect them

- **Self-Regulation**
Control disruptive impulses and think before acting
- **Social Regulation**
Build relationships and influence others' emotions



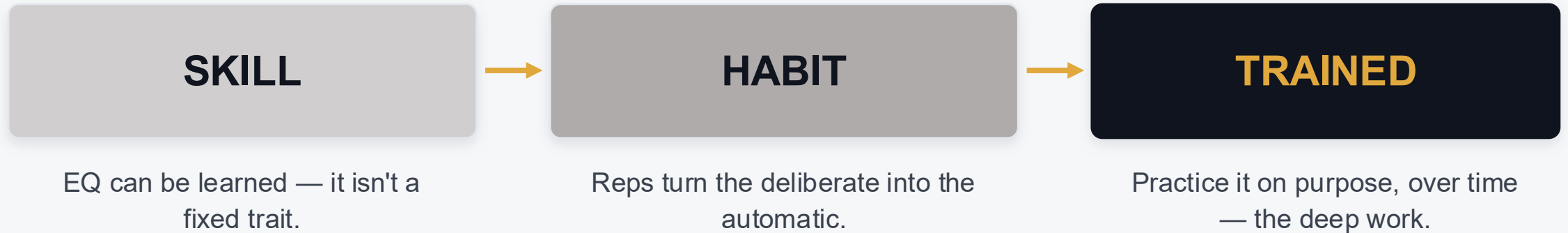


EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE 2.0

Vs

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE HABITS

A skill becomes a trained habit



*This is the deliberate work — real, lasting change.
And it takes time.*

Repetition & Reward



SKILL → HABIT → TRAINED. THAT'S THE LONG GAME.

But what about a tool to use **in the moment?**

When the trigger fires and you've got seconds, not weeks.



SPEEDS OF PLANNING & DECISION

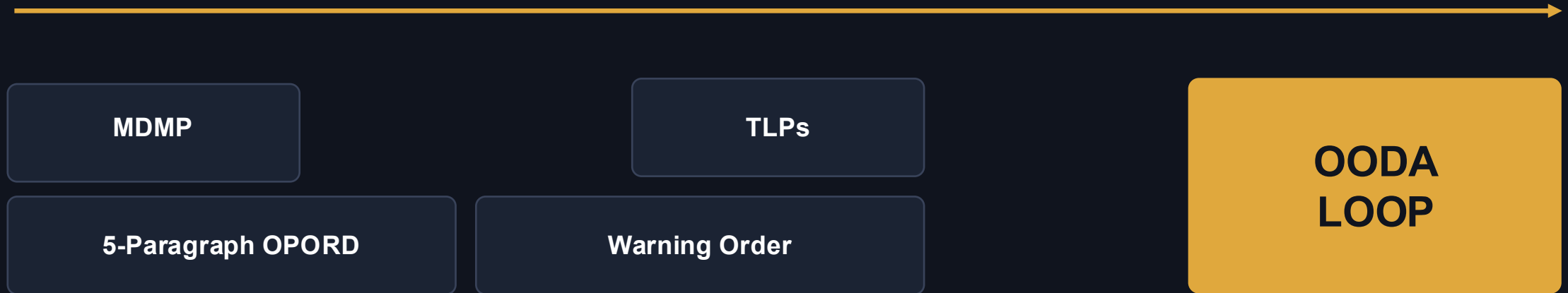
Planning at a every speed

DELIBERATE (Strategic)

time · depth · accuracy

IN THE MOMENT (Tactical)

speed · instinct · under fire



Trained on them. Used them. Taught them. The right model depends on how much time you have.





THE ORIGINAL LOOP

Where the loop comes from

- Colonel John Boyd — U.S. Air Force fighter pilot and military strategist.
- Nicknamed “**Forty-Second Boyd**”
- He saw U.S. pilots beat enemy jets that out-classed them on paper and concluded the edge wasn't the machine. It was **tempo**.

Speed of decision, not horsepower, won the fight.



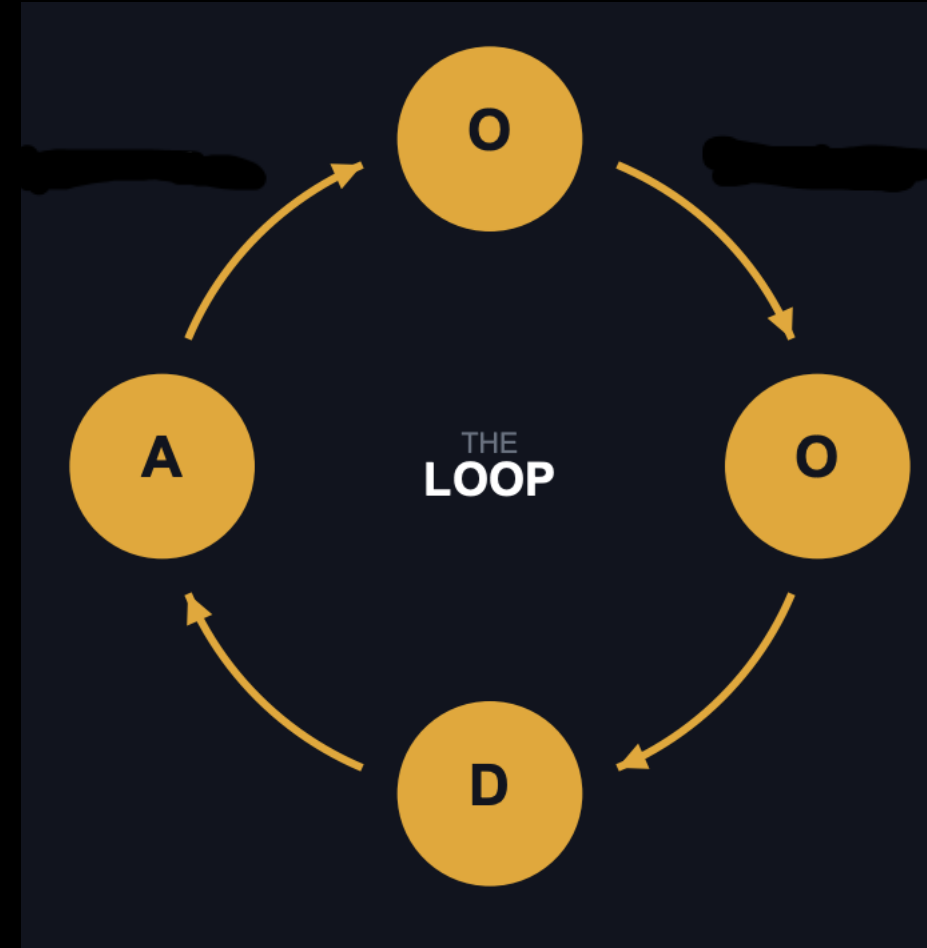


HOW IT WORKS

Observe · Orient · Decide · Act

A continuous decision cycle for acting under uncertainty and time pressure.

- **Observe** — take in what's actually happening.
 - **Orient** — make sense of what matters to the goal.
 - **Decide** — choose a response.
 - **Act** — execute, then loop again with what's changed.
- The aim: cycle faster than your opponent so they're reacting to a reality that's already moved.



Agility, not raw speed, wins.

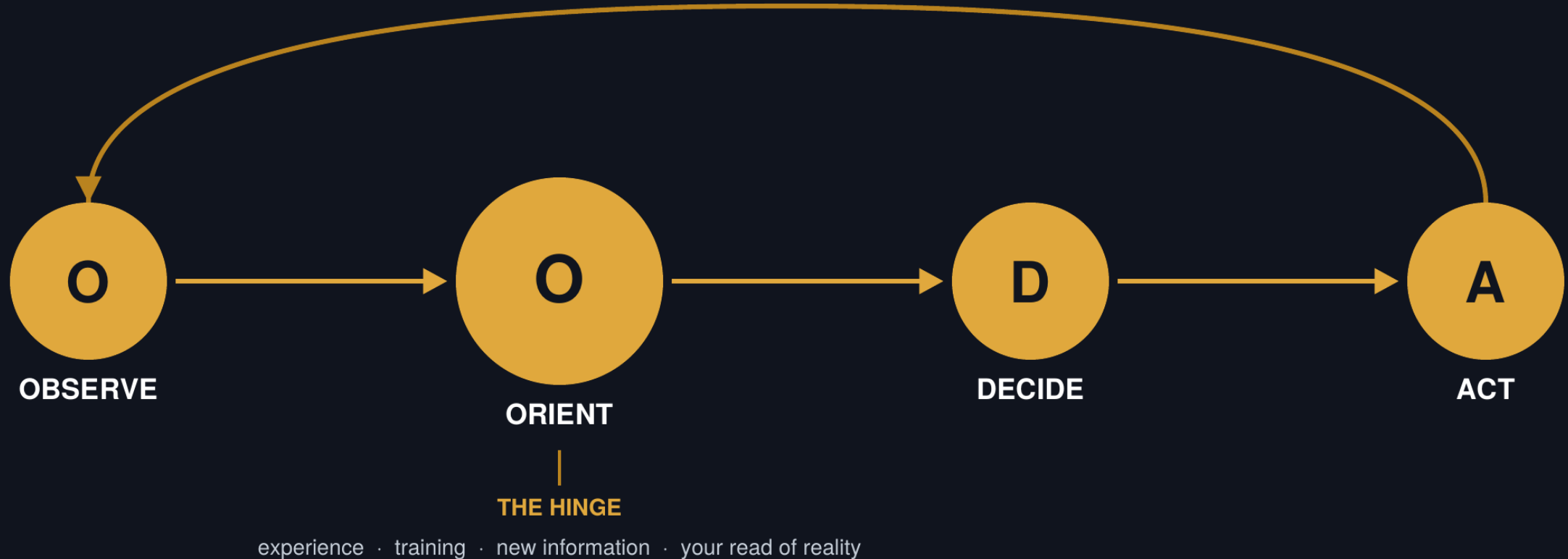


HOW IT WORKS

THE OODA LOOP

John Boyd's decision cycle — run it faster than your opponent

the loop — and the faster side wins



Agility, not raw speed, wins.



WHERE IT'S USED

From the cockpit to everywhere

Boyd's loop spread far past air combat:

- Ground and Naval maneuver-warfare doctrine
- Business strategy, cybersecurity, and law enforcement
- Negotiation, emergency response, and sports

Anywhere two adaptive sides compete under pressure, the faster, sharper loop wins.

In every one of those, you win by going faster.
There's one fight where that's exactly what beats you...

THE TOOL, IN ONE LINE

Downrange, you win by cycling the loop **FASTER** than your enemy.

At home and on your team, you win by running it **SLOWER** than your amygdala.

Same loop. Inverted speed.



THE SAME IS TRUE FOR EQ

Your emotions run the same line

THE DELIBERATE WORK

Skill becomes habit becomes trained. Coaching, repetitive reps, the long game.

Transformational and it takes time.

IN THE MOMENT

A tool you can use when the trigger fires and you've got two seconds — not two weeks.

Today's takeaway.

You can't run the Military Decision-Making Process when contact's three seconds out.

You can't build a VTO mid-blowup.

Here's a tool for the moment.



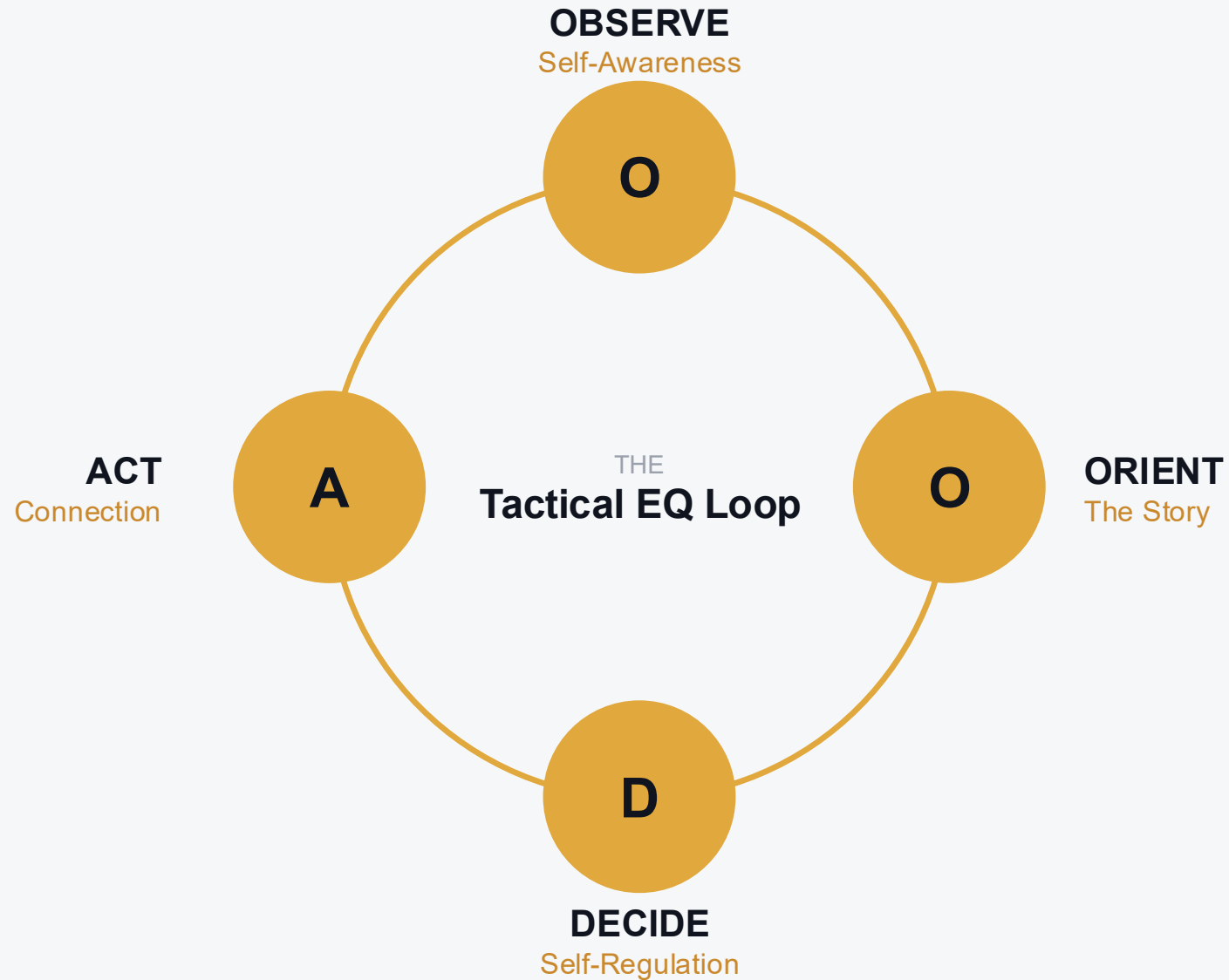
02 The Tactical EQ Loop

The combat decision cycle — turned inward.



THE FOUR DOMAINS — NOW AS A LOOP

One loop, four moves





SELF-AWARENESS

Observe

Catch the signal before it drives you.

- Name your physical tells: jaw, chest, heat, the change in your voice.
- Most leaders can read a room but can't read themselves.
- You can't manage a state you can't notice.





THE STORY

Orient

The make-or-break stage.

- Between the event and your reaction is a story you're telling yourself.
- Boyd called Orient the decisive stage; shaped by training, past wounds, bias.
- Ask: What else could this mean? What's the real problem here?





SELF-REGULATION

Decide

Create the gap. Then choose.

- The space between stimulus and response is where leadership lives.
- Choose a response instead of firing your default.
- Slower than your amygdala...on purpose.





CONNECTION

Act

Engage to connect, not to win.

- Your limbic system is an open loop: your state regulates the room.
- Calm is contagious. So is the hijack.
- Then read the feedback...and the loop starts again.



03 Run a rep

Reading about the loop won't change you. Flying it will.



Run one real moment through the loop

Pick one moment in the last 30 days you reacted at combat speed — before your thinking brain caught up — **and paid for it.**



OBSERVE

What were your physical tells?



ORIENT

What story did you tell?
What's one truer read?



DECIDE

What would 'slower' have looked like?



ACT

What would connecting — not winning — have looked like?

In pairs. You never have to share the moment — only run the process.



ONE THING TO EXECUTE

Before you leave this room

My most common trigger is ...

The one rep I'll run next time it fires is ...





THE RECAP

If you remember three things

- **The hijack is real.**

Under pressure, your brain jumps from Observe straight to Act — skipping Orient and Decide.

- **The loop buys back the gap.**

Observe · Orient · Decide · Act, run slower than your amygdala. The pause is the skill.

- **Lead yourself, then others.**

Regulated isn't connected — once you're steady, close the gap to the room.

You felt it work today. The rest is reps.



THE BOTTOM LINE

EQ isn't who you are.
It's a skill you train.

Marcus Truman · Archangel Performance Coaching

OPTIMIZING LEADERSHIP - UNLEASHING PERFORMANCE

KEEP THE MODEL

Take the loop with you.

Scan the card. Keep the Tactical EQ Loop model, get a guided rep, and tell me the one moment you most want to handle differently.

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